

2026 Medical Emoji: Microsoft Internal Decision Brief

Prepared: July 12, 2026

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Status: Internal review draft. This document does not represent Microsoft sponsorship, approval, or an implementation commitment.

Decision requested

Please identify the Microsoft standards, Windows/Segoe UI Emoji, design, and legal owners who can decide whether to:

1. advance **Ultrasound** as the conditional 2026 lead;
2. retain **CT Scan** as the operational fallback; and
3. authorize only the product, design, rights, and process statements those owners have expressly approved.

Recommendation

Run a short pass/fail review of Ultrasound. If every gate below closes by the internal cutoff, advance it. If any gate remains open, complete the CT Scan refresh and use CT Scan as the fallback. File neither until its full packet passes final review.

Ultrasound has the strongest upside in the expanded slate. No matching concept was found in Unicode's public proposal-status record, its recent Google Books signal is approximately 1.70 times the required elephant comparator, and a monitor-plus-probe image can represent obstetric, cardiac, abdominal, bedside, procedure-guidance, education, and veterinary uses without depicting a patient or diagnosis.

Ultrasound is not submission-ready today. It is missing four required Google screenshots, and the artwork still needs recognition review at 18 x 18 pixels and in black and white. CT Scan already contains all five required evidence categories, but its 2020 captures, current factor labels, and the submitter's explicit ownership warranty should be refreshed before filing.

Pass/fail gate

Ultrasound becomes the lead only when all four items are complete:

- Fresh Google Search and Google Video Search screenshots show a large, relevant result set.
- Worldwide Google Trends Web Search and Image Search comparisons against elephant show sustained usage.
- Microsoft design reviewers confirm that the probe remains recognizable at 18 x 18 pixels and that the monitor does not read as a generic computer.
- The product and legal owners clear the selected artwork, rights record, and any Microsoft-facing statement that will appear in the proposal.

Current evidence blocker: on July 12, the available capture environment received HTTP 429 from Google Trends and a CAPTCHA from Google Search. No substitute screenshot should be presented as compliant evidence. The four captures require a clean manual session on an accepted network.

Portfolio boundary

Kidney, Stomach, and Liver were declined on November 4, 2022. Unicode's current guidance says that emoji declined within the last four years are not eligible for re-review. Because the 2026 intake closes July 31, these concepts should not be filed this cycle. The redesigned v1.7 artwork and proposals are review assets for a future eligible cycle, not 2026 submissions.

Do not route the full portfolio as simultaneous proposals. One selected imaging concept gives Microsoft reviewers a bounded design and rights decision and reduces the open-ended-category risk.

Microsoft role and guardrails

- Confirm the proper standards route and the responsible internal owners.
- Review technical recognizability, accessibility, image rights, and accurate product language.
- Keep Shuhan He as the sole preparer and individual submitter unless another person expressly agrees to authorship.
- Do not describe Microsoft as sponsoring, endorsing, or committing to implementation unless the responsible owners approve that exact statement in writing.
- Request ordinary Unicode technical review, never a preferred outcome.

Official Unicode proposal guidance, including the 2026 intake dates, evidence requirements, and four-year re-review rule:

<https://www.unicode.org/emoji/proposals.html>